SUPERSEDING
MIL-I-19689A(MC)
30 June 1965

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

INSIGNIA, OFFICER CANDIDATE AND PLATOON LEADERS CLASS

1. SCOPE

*1.1 Scope. This specification covers requirements for distinctive metal insignia.

*1.2 Classification. The insignia shall be of the following types and classes, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Insignia, Officer Candidate
Type II - Insignia, Platoon Leaders Class
Class 1 - gold
Class 2 - silver

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

*2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation of bids or request for proposal, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-676 - Box, Setup.

MILITARY

MIL-B-17757 - Boxes, Fiber, Corrugated (Modular Sizes).

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-151 - Metal, Test Methods.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures And Tables For Inspection By Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking For Shipment And Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, or request for proposal shall apply.

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE
Uniform Freight Classification Rules

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Freight Classification Committee, 202 Chicago Union Station, Chicago, Illinois 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Samples. Samples are furnished solely for guidance and information to the supplier (see 6.3). Variation from this specification may appear in the sample, in which case the specification shall govern.

*3.2 First article. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, a finished insignia shall be submitted, or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for approval. The approval of the first article authorizes the commencement of production, but does not relieve the supplier of responsibility for compliance with all provisions of this specification. The first article shall be manufactured by the supplier in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

3.3 Materials.

*3.3.1 Copper base alloy. When tested as specified in 4.3.6, the chemical composition of the copper base alloy shall be 84.0 to 86.0 percent copper, 0.05 percent maximum lead, 0.05 percent maximum iron, 0.15 percent maximum total other elements and remainder percent zinc. The color shall be the basis of acceptability of the metal for composition except in case of dispute, when an analysis shall be made. The alloy shall be free from pits, scale (including red oxide), dents, nicks, cracks, deep scratches, segregations and foreign inclusions that cannot be removed in later processing.

3.3.2 Plating. Type I insignia and type II, class 2, insignia shall be plated with nickel and rhodium. Type II, class 1, insignia shall be plated with 24-karat gold.

*3.3.3 Hard solder. Hard solder shall be an alloy of silver having a melting point of not less than 1,075°F.

3.3.4 Lacquer. Lacquer shall be a pale, clear, synthetic lacquer. The use of pigmented lacquer shall not be permitted.

3.4 Design. The stamped design of the insignia shall be true impressions of the dies extracted from hubs furnished by the Government.

*3.5 Hubs and dies. The hubs shall be furnished by the Government and the dies shall be furnished by the supplier. The hub furnished by the Government shall be used only for making the supplier's working dies. The supplier's dies shall be tooled and polished to remove any dents, nicks, scratches or imperfections. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), dies furnished by the supplier shall remain his property. Upon completion of the contract, the hubs shall be returned to a point designated by the contracting officer. The supplier shall be held responsible for the loss, damage or mutilation of these hubs while in his possession. Determination of cost of replacing any lost, broken or damaged hubs shall be made by the Government.

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3.6 Construction. Dies shall be sunk in a manner to insure a well defined die-struck edge, and the insignia shall be accurately finished to the die struck edge. All edges shall be clean and smooth, free from burrs, drag, step or rough edges.

*3.6.1 Attaching device. The attaching device shall be the prong and wing type clutch fastener shown in Figure 1. The clutch shall be made from any type brass and the prong shall be made from nickel silver (63 to 66.5 percent copper, 16.5 to 19.5 percent nickel, 0.10 percent maximum lead, 0.25 percent maximum manganese, and the remainder zinc). Clutch fasteners shall withstand the test specified in 4.4.1. Prongs shall be soldered or electronically fused to the back of the insignia, located as shown in Figure 1. The soldered parts shall be completely joined without excess solder. All flux shall be removed and the joint shall be clean, strong, smooth, free from burned or reduced areas, and shall withstand the tests specified in 4.4.2.

3.6.2 Plating.

3.6.2.1 Gold plating. Type II, class 1, insignia shall be acid test gold plated. Prior to plating, the insignia shall be cleaned of matter that may affect the gold plating. The plating shall be nonporous, continuous and unbroken over the entire plated surface. There shall be no cut-through, peeled or blistered plating. The use of white metals as an undercoating for gold shall not be permitted. The plating shall withstand the test specified in 4.4.3.

*3.6.2.2 Nickel and rhodium plating. Type I insignia and type II, class 2, insignia shall have a nickel underplating not less than 0.0003 inch thick and shall then be plated with rhodium. The rhodium plating shall be done with not less than 1 gram per 1,000 square inches of surface, and for the purpose of this specification, the insignia shall be considered properly plated with rhodium if the test specified in 4.4.4 is met. Prior to plating, the insignia shall be cleaned of all matter that may affect the plating. The plating shall be nonporous, continuous and unbroken over the entire plated surface. There shall be no cut-through, peeled or blistered plating.

3.6.3 Lacquering. The fronts and edges of type II, class 1, insignia shall be thoroughly lacquered, or the entire insignia may be lacquered. The dry lacquer film shall be continuous, level, adherent, and free from lint, dust or other foreign inclusions that may affect appearance or serviceability. The lacquered insignia shall withstand the test for tackiness specified in 4.4.5.

*3.7 Finish. The fronts and edges of all insignia shall have a mirror-like finish. Backs shall be clean and smooth. The color of the gold plated insignia shall be that of 24-karat gold. The color of the rhodium plated insignia shall be that of silver. The face and edges of all insignia shall match that of the standard sample for color and finish; however, such finishing shall not be carried to the point where edges are so rounded or so detailed in design as to fail to meet requirements of 3.4.

3.8 Finished dimensions.

*3.8.1 Type I. The overall finished dimensions of type I insignia shall be 7/8 inch wide by 1/2 inch high. The finished dimensions of the individual letters shall be 3/8 inch wide by 1/2 inch high. Angled corners of the letter shall finish on a 45° angle, and beveled edges of the letters shall finish on a 45° angle with a 1/64 inch bevel. The segments of the letters and the connecting bars between the letters shall be 1/8 inch wide. The finished thickness of the insignia shall be 0.062 inch minimum (min) at the letters and 0.049 inch min at the connecting bars.

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3.8.2 Type II. The overall finished measurements of type II insignia shall be 1-3/16 inches wide by 1/2 inch high. The finished dimensions of the individual letters shall be as follows: The letters P and C shall be 3/8 inch at the widest parts by 1/2 inch high, and the letter L shall be 11/32 inch wide at the bottom edge by 1/2 inch high. Angled corners of the letters shall finish on a 45°angle, and beveled edges of the letters shall finish on a 45° angle with a 1/64 inch bevel. The segments of the letters and the connecting bars between the letters shall be 1/8 inch wide. The finished thickness of the insignia shall be 0.062 inch min at the letters and 0.049 inch min at the connecting bars.

*3.9 Workmanship. The finished insignia shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels (AQL).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

*4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

*4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. When a certificate of compliance is submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items and determine the validity of the certification.

*4.2 Inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated herein.

*4.2.1 First article inspection. When first article is required, inspection and testing shall be made on a completely fabricated insignia of each type and class for all provisions of this specification applicable to end item examination and tests.

*4.2.2 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document. In addition, testing shall be performed on the component listed in Table I for the characteristic shown.

*4.2.2.1 Certification of compliance. Components and materials listed below may be accepted on the basis of a contractor's certification of compliance for characteristics indicated:

Component	Characteristic	Rqmt para.
Gold for plating	Material identification and karat	3.3.2
	White metal not used as undercoating	3.6.2.1
Hard solder	Material identification	3.3.3
Lacquer	Material identification	3.3.4
Clutch and prong	Material identification	3.6.1

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Table I. Component testing

Component	Characteristic	Rqmt para.	Test method	Rqmt appl to Spl unit	Rqmt appl to Lot avg	No. Determinations per sample unit	Results rptd as	Sample insp unit Level AQL
Copper base alloy (1 pound)	Chemical composition	3.3.1	4.4.6	-	X	2 for each element	To nearest 0.1 percent	8 oz. S-1 N/A or equivalent

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*4.2.3 Inspection of the end item. The defects found during examination shall be classified in accordance with 4.2.3.1 and 4.2.3.2. The sample unit for these examinations shall be one insignia of each type and class. All defects shall be as indicated below, except those with an asterisk (*) in classification column, which shall be classified as follows:

Major defect - When seriously affecting serviceability or appearance

Minor defect - When affecting serviceability or appearance but not seriously.

*4.2.3.1 General defects. General defects shall be classified as follows:

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Color and finish	a. Does not compare favorably with standard or approved sample.	X	
	b. Face or any edge not mirror-like finished.	X	
	c. Surfaces not smooth.	*	
	d. Discoloration or stain clearly noticeable.	*	
	e. Abraded, scuffed, scratched or otherwise damaged.	*	
Plating	a. Not plated.	X	
	b. Not type specified.	X	
	c. Plating is not smooth, not continuous or not adherent.	X	
	d. Cut through or porous.	X	
Lacquering	a. Not lacquered or area of no film.	X	
	b. Area of thin film.		X
	c. Lacquer not clear.		X
	d. Not adherent, i.e., blistered, flaking or peeling.	*	
	e. Foreign matter imbedded.	*	
	f. Discoloration clearly noticeable.	*	
	g. Coating not continuous, and level, i.e., runs, drips, or drops.	*	

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
	h. Coating is blushed, cloudy or hazy.		X
	i. Tacky finish.		X
Design	a. Detail altered and does not conform to Government hub.	X	
	b. Any warp, twist or distortion producing irregular surface contour or outline.		*
	c. Detail struck over, resulting in a double impression.	X	
Material	Not fabricated of the specified material.	X	
Construction and workmanship	a. Not one-piece stamping.	X	
	b. Not trimmed to die struck edge.		*
	c. Not pierced where required.	X	
	d. Piercing not clean and smooth, e.g., any burrs, cutter drill or file marks.		*
	e. Design or shape altered by piercing.		*
	f. Dent, pit, dig, gouge, nick, pores, metal mark, or mutilation.		*
	g. Distorted, bent, malformed, or otherwise impaired.		*
	h. Burr, fin, rough or sharp edge, drag or step.		*
	i. Metal cracked or fractured.	X	
Attaching device	a. Not specified type, size or material.	X	
	b. Any component missing.	X	
	c. Defective, e.g., any part damaged or malformed affecting use.		*
	d. Not positioned as specified.		*
	e. Clutch will not engage prong, or is loose fit.		*

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Soldering	a. Prong not completely joined by solder.		*
	b. Any area burned or reduced in soldering.		*
	c. Flux or excess solder not removed.		X
	d. Prong is loose.	X	
	e. Prong is bent out of shape or otherwise impaired.		*

*4.2.3.2 Examination of insignia for dimensions. Any dimension that is not within the specified tolerances shall be classified as a defect.

*4.2.3.3 Inspection levels and AQL's. The inspection levels and AQL's expressed in defects per hundred units (DHU) shall be as follows:

	Inspection Level	AQL Major	Total
For defects applicable to 4.2.3.1	II	2.5	15.0
For defects applicable to 4.2.3.2	S-2	(one class)	4.0

*4.2.4 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine compliance with packaging, packing and marking requirements in Section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 DHU.

Examine	Defect
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing. Any component damaged, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of case liners, container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of containers.
Weight or content (exterior and interior)	Number of intermediate containers is more or less than required; gross/net weight exceeds requirements.

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*4.2.4.1 Examination for count of insignia in intermediate containers. Insignia packaged for shipment shall be examined to determine conformance with package markings and specified quantity. The sample unit for this examination shall be one box (intermediate container). Any box containing less than the specified or marked quantity of insignia shall be classified as a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 DHU. The lot size shall be the number of intermediate containers in one shipping container.

*4.3 Testing of the end item. Testing of the completely fabricated insignia shall be performed in accordance with Table II for the characteristics shown therein. The sample unit shall be two completely fabricated insignia of each type and class. The requirements are applicable to the individual unit. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 6.5 DHU.

4.4 Tests.

*4.4.1 Test for clutch fastener. Insignia shall have the clutch fasteners removed and replaced at least 10 times. After being so tested, it shall be impossible to shake the clutch off or remove it by hand without first releasing the clutch spring.

*4.4.2 Tests for soldered and fused joints. Insignia to be tested shall be placed in an oven maintained at 1,075°F ±10°F, for not less than 15 minutes. While at the specified temperature, the insignia shall be lifted by one of the prongs without the soldered parts separating. Fused prongs shall be bent back and forth, at room temperature, through an angle of 90° at least ten times or until prong breaks without separation at the fused joint.

*4.4.3 Test for acid test gold plating. Pieces selected may be unlacquered or have the lacquer completely removed with an organic solvent. The test acid shall be applied as follows: place a drop of test acid (each drop to be 1/8 inch diameter min) on three different spots on the gold plated surface of the insignia, allowing the drops to remain on the insignia for not less than 2 minutes. If visible chemical action appears, such as evolution of gas, the plating will be considered porous, cut through, peeled, blistered, or insufficient, thereby failing to meet specification requirements. The plating may be considered satisfactory if no visible chemical action appears. The test acid applied at room temperature shall consist of a solution containing 50 percent by volume of CP nitric acid (specific gravity 1.42) and equal volume of distilled water.

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Table II. End item testing

Characteristic	Rqmt para.	Test method	No. Determinations per sample unit	Results reported as
Test for clutch fastener	3.6.1	4.4.1	1	Pass or fail
Test for soldered or fused joints	3.6.1	4.4.2	1	Pass or fail
Test for acid test gold plating	3.6.2.1	4.4.3	1	Pass or fail
Test for continuity of rhodium plating	3.6.2.2	4.4.4	1	Pass or fail
Nickel underplating Material identification	3.6.2.2	Std. Comm'l	1	Pass or fail
Plating thickness	3.6.2.2	Std. Comm'l	1	To nearest 0.00001 inch
Tackiness test for lacquer film	3.6.3	4.4.5	1	Pass or fail

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*4.4.4 Test for continuity of rhodium plating. Test samples or rhodium plated insignia shall be immersed for 1 minute in a "liver of sulphur" solution (2 percent potassium sulfide and 98 percent water by weight) at a temperature of 100°F ±10°F. After removal, the insignia shall be washed clean in water, dried, and examined. There shall be no perceptible change in brightness on the plated surfaces, except along the edges, there may be a slight darkening.

4.4.5 Tackiness test for lacquer film. At room temperature (60° to 80° F), press a piece of tissue paper against the lacquered surfaces of the insignia for 15 seconds, using any pressure capable of being exerted between thumb and two fingers. The tissue paper shall not adhere to the insignia, but shall fall free when pressure is released.

*4.4.6 Chemical composition test. Chemical composition of the copper base alloy shall be determined in accordance with test method 111 of FED-STD-151. Results shall be evaluated to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.3.1.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

*5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

*5.1.1 Level A. One pair of insignia shall be mounted on cardboard having a minimum thickness of 0.011 inch and measuring 2-1/2 inches square with clutch fasteners assembled, and shall then be wrapped in tissue paper. As an alternate to the tissue wrap, each pair of mounted insignia shall be packaged in a snug fitting transparent polyethylene bag having a minimum film thickness of 0.002 inch. All seams and closures shall be effected by heat sealing. Prior to or during heat sealing closure operations, excess air within the bag shall be expelled. Sixty cards (120 insignia) of one type and class only shall be packaged in a paperboard intermediate inner container having outside dimensions of 7 inches long, 5-5/8 inches wide, and 2-1/2 inches high, The container shall conform to type I, variety 1, class A, style 4 of PPP-B-676, with the paperboard to be not less than 0.040 inch thick.

*5.1.2 Level C. Insignia shall be packaged in accordance with manufacturer's commercial practice.

*5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

*5.2.1 Level A.

*5.2.1.1 Method 1. Twelve intermediate containers (1,440 insignia) of one type and one class only packaged as specified in 5.1.1 shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container with liner, conforming to type CF, class weather resistant, style CSSC-L, size No. 1A, grade 275 of MIL-B-17757 and assembled, closed, and reinforced in accordance with the appendix thereto. Toward the end of the contract, or when there is less than the required amount per container of the same class, mixed classes may be packed within the same container (see 5.3.1).

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*5.2.1.2 Method 2. When specified (see 6.2), 12 shipping containers conforming to size 1A, Grade 275 of MIL-B-17757, containing 12 intermediate containers packaged as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, style FOL, size No. 4, grade V3C of MIL-B-17757. Shipping containers shall be assembled, closed, and reinforced as specified in the appendix thereto. Toward the end of the contract, or when there is less than the required amount per container of the same class, mixed classes may be packed in the same container (see 5.3.1).

***5.2.2 Level B. Twelve intermediate containers, (1440 insignia) of one type and class only and packaged as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container with liner, conforming to type CF, class domestic, style CSSC-L, size No. 1A of MIL-B-17757 and assembled, closed and reinforced in accordance with the appendix thereto. The fiberboard used in fabricating the box shall be grade 275. Toward the end of the contract, or when there is less than the required amount per container of the same class, mixed classes may be packed within the same container (see 5.3.1).**

***5.2.3 Level C. Insignia, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or regulations of other carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.**

*5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, intermediate and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of MIL-STD-129. The individual units packaged as specified in 5.1.1.2 shall be marked for purposes of identification by legibly printing or stamping the item nomenclature and Federal Stock Number in black lettering on either the mounting card or a paper label. When a paper label is used, it shall measure approximately 1 by 1 inches and shall be placed in each transparent bag with lettering facing out.

*5.3.1 Mixed classes. Each shipping container packed with mixed class shall have securely attached to the end and side, directly under the printing or stenciling, a white paper label 5 by 4 inches with the words "MIXED CLASSES" plainly stamped or printed thereon, and under these words shall be legibly printed the correct quantity of each contained therein.

6. NOTES

***6.1 Intended use. The insignia are intended for wear by male personnel of the U. S. Marine Corps, officer candidates and** members of the platoon leaders class.

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*6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

6.2.1 Procurement requirements.

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type and class required (1.2).
(c) Whether first article is required (see 3.2).
(d) When dies shall not remain property of supplier (3.5).
(e) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (5.1 and 5.2).
(f) When level A, Method 2, packing is required (5.2.1.2).

*6.2.2 Contract data requirements. Data conforming to Data Item Descriptions DI-R-4803, DI-R-4805, DI-T-4901, DI-T-4902, DI-T-4903 and DI-T-4904 will usually be required for delivery in connection with this specification. When so required, such data will be specified for delivery on a DD Form 1423 included in the contract.

6.3 Samples. For information regarding availability of sample insignia, address inquiry to the procuring activity issuing the invitation for bids.

*6.4 First article. Examination, test and approval shall be as specified by the contracting officer (see 3.2).

*6.5 Marginal notations. The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship of the last previous issue.

Preparing activity:
Navy - MC
Project No. 8455-N316

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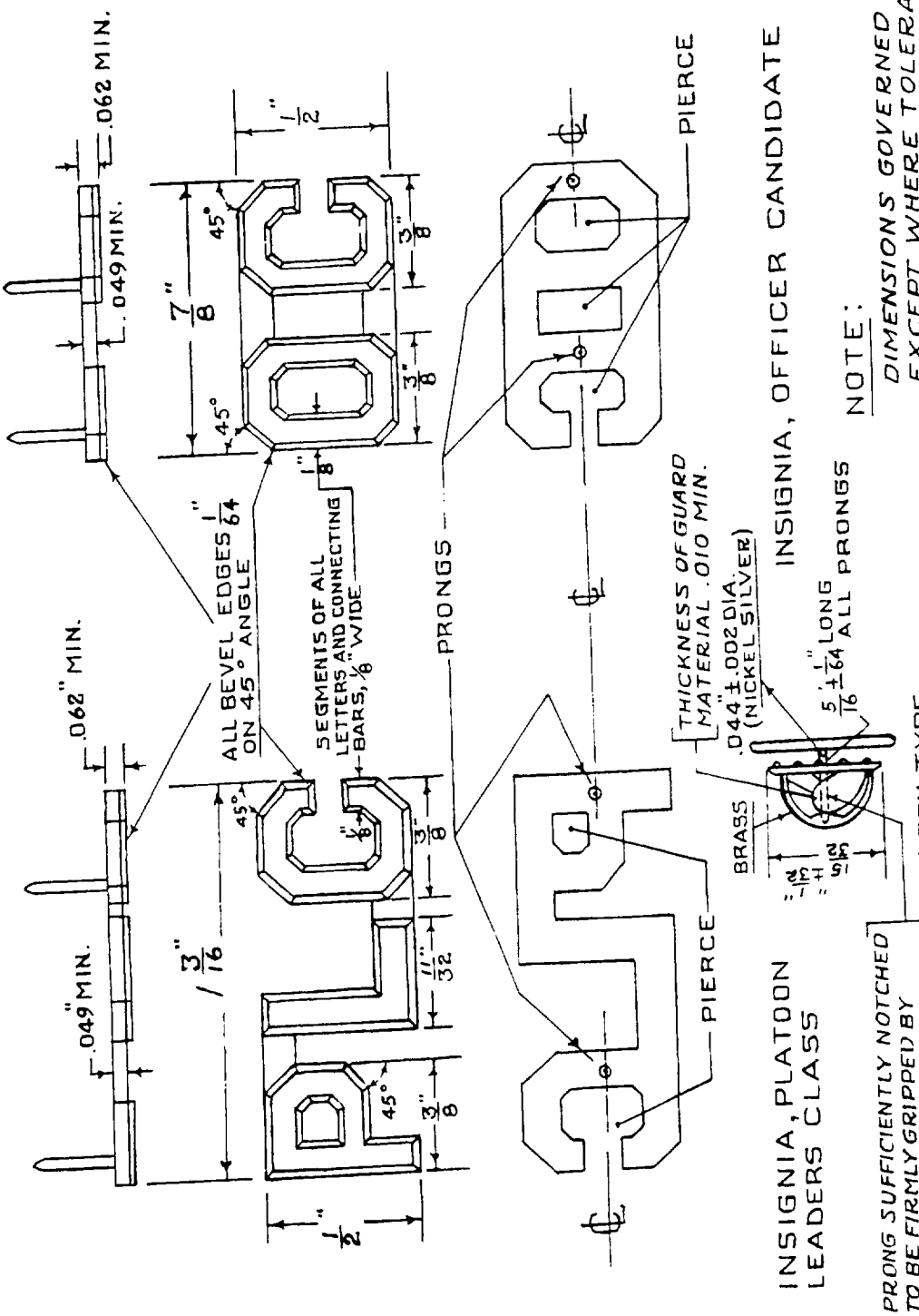


FIGURE 1. INSIGNIA, OFFICER CANDIDATE AND INSIGNIA, PLATOON LEADERS CLASS

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements.

SPECIFICATION

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)*

DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 66 1426

REPLACES EDITION OF 1 OCT 64 WHICH MAY BE USED.

S/N-0102-014-1801

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POSTAGE AND FEES PAI

OFFICIAL BUSINESS

Commanding General (826)
Marine Corps Supply Activity
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Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19146

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